

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 53)

Page 262 - Bridges and the Poetry Revival

Q1. A legend grew up that Bridges' poetry is passionless. How does the text respond to this?

- A. It entirely agrees with the legend
- B. It states that his poetry is not passionless, though it does not throb with undisciplined emotion
- C. It suggests his poetry is only passionate in his earlier works
- D. It claims his poetry is overly emotional

Answer: B

Q2. What did Robert Bridges always seek to naturalize in English poetry as an experimenter?

- A. Blank verse
- B. Classical metres
- C. The sonnet form
- D. The French ballade

Answer: B

Q3. What 'loose' metric form did Bridges invent and use in The Testament of Beauty?

- A. Loose hexameters
- B. Loose alexandrines
- C. Loose octameters
- D. Loose decasyllabics

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Answer: B

Q4. Why would Bridges have been more popular according to the text?

- A. If he had written more plays
- B. If he had had an obvious message for his generation
- C. If he had written novels instead
- D. If he had died younger

Answer: B

Q5. Bridges' succession to the laureateship in 1913 coincided with an effort by young poets to popularize what?

- A. Contemporary poetry
- B. Drama
- C. Epic poetry
- D. American literature

Answer: A

Q6. Which anthology of new verse was issued in the autumn of 1913, starting a boom in poetry?

- A. Lyrical Ballads
- B. Georgian Poetry
- C. Poems of Today
- D. The Golden Treasury

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Answer: B

Q7. Who was largely enterprising this 1913 anthology of new verse, along with editor Edward Marsh?

- A. Rupert Brooke
- B. Siegfried Sassoon
- C. John Masefield
- D. Julian Grenfell

Answer: A

Q8. What event gave the boom in poetry a further impetus by providing an outlet for unusually insistent emotions?

- A. The Great Depression
- B. The first World War
- C. The Boer War
- D. The death of Queen Victoria

Answer: B

Q9. On which island was Rupert Brooke flung into a premature grave during the war?

- A. Malta
- B. Skyros
- C. Crete
- D. Cyprus

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Answer: B

Q10. Which poet is singled out as giving the most sincere expression to courageous idealism in his poem 'Into Battle'?

- A. Rupert Brooke
- B. Siegfried Sassoon
- C. Julian Grenfell
- D. Ralph Hodgson

Answer: C

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Page 263 - Georgian Poets and Transition Dramatists

Q1. Which poet began the 'war of the fountain pen against the machine gun' in works like Counter Attack?

- A. Julian Grenfell
- B. Siegfried Sassoon
- C. Rupert Brooke
- D. John Masefield

Answer: B

Q2. Ralph Hodgson's poems, such as The Bull and The Song of Honour, are remarkable for what?

- A. Political satire and comedy
- B. Strength, imaginative force, subtle music, and masterly concentration
- C. Detailed historical narratives
- D. Free verse experimentation

Answer: B

Q3. Who was Robert Bridges' successor as Poet Laureate?

- A. Rupert Brooke
- B. John Masefield
- C. W. B. Yeats
- D. A. E. Housman

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Answer: B

Q4. What type of diction and fervour did John Masefield combine in his narrative poems after passing from sea songs?

- A. A rough vigour of diction with religious fervour
- B. Polished classical diction with atheism
- C. Highly scientific terminology with romanticism
- D. Strictly comedic dialogue with tragedy

Answer: A

Q5. In Reynard the Fox, the accurate adjustment of the metrical movement is managed to match what?

- A. The rhythm of a sailing ship
- B. The beat of the horses' hoofs and the increasing exhaustion of the fox
- C. The marching of soldiers
- D. The ticking of a clock

Answer: B

Q6. Which of Masefield's poems preludes the tremendous tragedy of the War with a moving sense of still loveliness over the English countryside?

- A. The Everlasting Mercy
- B. Dauber
- C. August 1914

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D. Biography

Answer: C

Q7. Whose work in stage naturalism in the eighteen-sixties prepared the way for Pinero and Jones?

A. T. W. Robertson

B. Bernard Shaw

C. Oscar Wilde

D. Henrik Ibsen

Answer: A

Q8. What type of play did A. W. Pinero and Henry Arthur Jones popularize in the eighties and nineties?

A. The poetic drama

B. The problem play

C. The farce

D. The historical pageant

Answer: B

Q9. Which of the following is true about Pinero and Jones as playwrights?

A. They were amateurish and lacked skill

B. They were unusually accomplished dramatic craftsmen (efficient)

C. They only wrote comedies of manners

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D. They rejected all traditional theatrical forms

Answer: B

Q10. In Henry Arthur Jones's play Mrs. Dane's Defence, what is described as being in substance wholly artificial, yet managed with genius?

A. The opening monologue

B. The interrogation of Felicia Hindmarsh by Sir Daniel Carteret

C. The comedic subplot

D. The tragic ending

Answer: B

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Page 264 - George Bernard Shaw

Q1. According to the text, what did the 'efficient' dramatists (creators of 'the well-made play') neglect to take into the theatre?

- A. Comedy
- B. Life
- C. Scenery
- D. Music

Answer: B

Q2. Who brought about a revolution in the drama by hauling Life unceremoniously into the theatre?

- A. A. W. Pinero
- B. Henry Arthur Jones
- C. Bernard Shaw
- D. J. M. Barrie

Answer: C

Q3. In what traditional almost-penniless condition did Shaw come to London in 1876?

- A. From Edinburgh
- B. From Dublin
- C. From Cardiff
- D. From Paris

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Answer: B

Q4. What passion drove Shaw to impose himself upon the theatre?

- A. A desire for wealth
- B. A moral passion for the establishment of righteousness in social relationships
- C. A passion for classical literature
- D. A love of acting

Answer: B

Q5. When Shaw dragged Life into the theatre, his plays began to talk about what?

- A. Kings and queens
- B. Housing conditions, religion, finance, prostitution
- C. Pure romantic fantasies
- D. Abstract aesthetics

Answer: B

Q6. What did the stage become by Shaw's contrivance?

- A. A museum of antiquities
- B. The ventilating shaft of modern civilisation
- C. A purely aesthetic space
- D. A place for religious worship

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Answer: B

Q7. Between Widowers' Houses and Candida, how did Shaw develop?

- A. From a propagandist to a playwright dealing with real problems and nearly-real people
- B. From a realist to a romancer
- C. From a comedian to a tragedian
- D. From a poet to a novelist

Answer: A

Q8. In Man and Superman, what philosophic idea did Shaw present?

- A. The Death Drive
- B. The Life Force
- C. The Absolute Spirit
- D. The Categorical Imperative

Answer: B

Q9. According to Man and Superman, what is the purpose of the Life Force?

- A. To destroy the world
- B. To energize man to produce a higher type of creature, the Superman
- C. To maintain the status quo
- D. To return to nature

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Answer: B

Q10. Faced with man's inertia, who does the Life Force select as the more willing instrument in evolving the Superman?

A. Children

B. Woman

C. The government

D. Scientists

Answer: B

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Page 265 - Shaw (Contd.) and Irish Drama

Q1. In which play did Shaw's conception of a Life Force merge into his larger theory of Creative Evolution?

- A. Heartbreak House
- B. Saint Joan
- C. Back to Methuselah
- D. The Doctor's Dilemma

Answer: C

Q2. As a dramatist, Shaw's unmatched abilities lay in his combination of effervescing wit and what?

- A. Melancholic despair
- B. Strong commonsense
- C. Mystical poetry
- D. Tragic pacing

Answer: B

Q3. Which of Shaw's works comes nearest to the general idea of what a good play should be?

- A. Back to Methuselah
- B. Man and Superman
- C. Saint Joan
- D. Widowers' Houses

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Answer: C

Q4. Which of Shaw's plays is noted for its prophetic vision?

- A. Candida
- B. You Never Can Tell
- C. Saint Joan
- D. Heartbreak House

Answer: D

Q5. For roughly ten years up to 1899, who strove to bring into existence an Irish National Theatre?

- A. J. M. Synge
- B. Sean O'Casey
- C. William Butler Yeats
- D. George William Russell

Answer: C

Q6. Which of the following is a notable poetic play contributed by W. B. Yeats?

- A. Deirdre
- B. The Countess Cathleen
- C. Riders to the Sea
- D. Juno and the Paycock

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Answer: B

Q7. Writing under the pseudonym 'A.E.', who became an honoured figure as poet, dramatist, and agricultural reformer?

A. W. B. Yeats

B. George William Russell

C. J. M. Synge

D. Lady Gregory

Answer: B

Q8. The Irish National Theatre was housed at which theatre in Dublin?

A. The Globe Theatre

B. The Abbey Theatre

C. The Gate Theatre

D. The Lyric Theatre

Answer: B

Q9. Who was the chief of the capable body of new dramatists in the first period of the Irish National Theatre?

A. Sean O'Casey

B. Lady Gregory

C. J. M. Synge

D. W. B. Yeats

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Answer: C

Q10. Which of the following plays was written by J. M. Synge?

- A. The Land of Heart's Desire
- B. The Playboy of the Western World
- C. The Silver Tassie
- D. Juno and the Paycock

Answer: B

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Page 266 - Irish Drama (Contd.) and Barrie

Q1. Who was acclaimed for two plays of contemporary town life in Ireland: Juno and the Paycock (1925) and The Plough and the Stars (1926)?

- A. J. M. Synge
- B. Sean O'Casey
- C. Lady Gregory
- D. W. B. Yeats

Answer: B

Q2. Which of Sean O'Casey's plays are described as less comprehensible experimental pieces?

- A. Juno and the Paycock
- B. Riders to the Sea
- C. The Silver Tassie and Within the Gates
- D. Seven Short Plays

Answer: C

Q3. Who contributed a succession of uncommonly well-observed little plays of modern Irish life and character, such as Seven Short Plays?

- A. Miss A. E. F. Horniman
- B. Lady Gregory
- C. Sean O'Casey

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D. George William Russell

Answer: B

Q4. Who wrote the history of the modern Irish drama in *Our Irish Theatre*?

A. W. B. Yeats

B. Lady Gregory

C. J. M. Synge

D. A.E.

Answer: B

Q5. While Shaw dealt with specific modern problems, what did J. M. Barrie deal with in terms of fantasy?

A. Men and women in situations as familiar or unfamiliar in one generation as in another

B. Purely political subjects

C. Strictly scientific matters

D. Historical biographies

Answer: A

Q6. In settled pessimism, where did J. M. Barrie take refuge from the ugliness of modern life?

A. In socialist politics

B. In a world of delicate sentiment and make-believe

C. In strict religious dogma

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D. In classical antiquity

Answer: B

Q7. In which play did Barrie skirt about the edges of a modern problem only to fly from its full implications in the last act?

A. Peter Pan

B. The Admirable Crichton

C. Dear Brutus

D. Quality Street

Answer: B

Q8. How is Barrie described as a humorist?

A. Bitter and cynical

B. Sunnily human and wryly disillusioned

C. Slapstick and loud

D. Highly intellectual and obscure

Answer: B

Q9. As the author of Peter Pan, which kind of critic did Barrie completely satisfy?

A. The academic critic

B. The dramatic reviewer

C. The critic in the nursery

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D. The political theorist

Answer: C

Q10. Whose creation of Alice in 1865 is described as one of those strokes of sublime genius that do not occur more than once or twice?

A. Lewis Carroll

B. J. M. Barrie

C. Edward Lear

D. Kenneth Grahame

Answer: A